

Morning Briefing — 23 June 2026

Generated: 06:45 BST | London pre-open | Data collected 05:30–06:45 BST

2. Important News

US-Iran MoU entered force; Strait of Hormuz reopens, sanctions lifted

Source: Al Jazeera / OilPrice.com | **Why it matters:** Ends an estimated 14 million bbl/day supply shortfall; Brent has collapsed from the late-April peak of \$119 and is now sub-\$78. A 60-day window for a permanent settlement; failure to comply would reprice oil sharply higher again.

Fed rate hike probability hits 70% for September; 10Y Treasury briefly at 4.5%

Source: CNBC / CME FedWatch | **Why it matters:** 9 of 19 Fed policymakers now project at least one hike before year-end. \$69B 2-year note auction today is a direct test of demand at these yield levels. DXY at its highest since May 2025 is weighing on gold and commodities.

Russell 2000 closes at 3,000 for the first time in history (June 22)

Source: TheStreet | **Why it matters:** Historic milestone signals broad market breadth beyond mega-cap tech. Small-cap outperformed Russell 1000 over the past year; total RUT market cap rose from \$2.7T to \$3.5T. Watch for institutional flow follow-through today.

ECB raised key rates 25bp to 2.25%; EUR/USD softens to 1.143

Source: ECB / Forex.com | **Why it matters:** Policy tightening in Europe while the Fed also eyes hikes creates an unusual dual-tightening dynamic. ECB projects Eurozone headline inflation at 3.0% in 2026. EUR/USD soft because the Fed's hawkish pivot and dollar rate advantage outweigh the ECB move.

UK PM Keir Starmer resigned; sterling under pressure

Source: Forex.com / Reuters | **Why it matters:** Political leadership vacuum in the UK introduces fiscal policy uncertainty. GBP/USD holding near 1.34 but vulnerable to a renewed sell-off if no credible successor is named quickly.

3. European Futures — Pre-Open

DATA AS OF ~06:30 BST

INDEX	FUTURES LEVEL	VS YESTERDAY CLOSE	IMPLIED MOVE
Euro Stoxx 50	6,326	+24 pts	+0.38%
DAX 40	n/a	n/a	n/a
CAC 40	n/a	n/a	n/a
FTSE 100	n/a	n/a	n/a
S&P 500 (E-mini)	n/a	n/a	n/a
Nasdaq 100	n/a	n/a	n/a

Euro Stoxx 50 futures sourced from Barchart/Investing.com. DAX, CAC, FTSE pre-open data not available at time of collection. Sources: Barchart, Investing.com

4. Yesterday's Closes — 22 June 2026

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE	% CHANGE
Euro Stoxx 50	6,302	-19 pts	-0.30%
DAX 40	n/a	n/a	n/a
CAC 40	n/a	n/a	n/a
FTSE 100	n/a	n/a	n/a

DAX, CAC, FTSE June 22 closing levels not available from sources at time of collection. Source: Yahoo Finance / Trading Economics

5. US Markets — 22 June 2026 Session

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE	% CHANGE
S&P 500	n/a level	—	+0.12%
Dow Jones	n/a level	+148 pts	+0.29%
Nasdaq Composite	n/a level	—	-0.27%
Russell 2000	3,000 ★ Record	—	Historic milestone

Session tone: Mixed. Small-caps set an all-time record with the Russell 2000 closing at 3,000 for the first time ever. The Dow and S&P 500 closed marginally higher while the Nasdaq slipped, pressured by elevated yields. Energy was the worst-performing sector, down 5.63% month-to-date as oil prices collapsed following the US-Iran deal and Hormuz reopening. Chip shares provided a modest tailwind to the Nasdaq but were insufficient to offset broader rate-sensitivity headwinds. Breadth was positive. Key takeaway: markets are rewarding cyclicals and small-caps while punishing yield-sensitive tech.

Sources: TheStreet, CNBC, James Investment

6. Asian Markets — Overnight Session (June 23)

INDEX	LEVEL	% CHANGE
Nikkei 225	71,250	+0.28%
Hang Seng	23,769	-0.70%
Shanghai Composite	4,090	-0.43%
Kospi	n/a	n/a

Overall tone: Mixed. The Nikkei edged higher, supported by easing oil-price pressure benefiting Japanese manufacturers and airlines. Hong Kong and Shanghai declined as investors stayed cautious on the Fed rate hike trajectory and US-China trade uncertainty. Sentiment was partly underpinned by progress in US-Iran talks but the Hang Seng extended losses for a fourth consecutive session, recovering from an intraday dip of nearly 2%.

Sources: Yahoo Finance, moneyandbanking.co.th, CNBC Asia

7. Commodities

DATA AS OF ~06:00 BST

COMMODITY	PRICE	UNIT	DAILY CHANGE	CONTEXT
Brent Crude	~\$77.00	\$/bbl	Declining trend	Down from \$119 late-April peak; Hormuz reopening. Approx. estimate; check live data.
WTI Crude	\$73.67	\$/bbl	-0.26%	Iran MoU eliminates ~14M bbl/day supply shortfall.
Gold	\$4,132.97	\$/oz	-1.40%	USD strength (DXY 100.9) and reduced haven demand as Iran deal reduces geopolitical premium.
Natural Gas	\$3.06	\$/MMBtu	n/a (Jun 15 data)	Henry Hub; latest available data as of June 15.
Copper (LME)	\$6.35	\$/lb	Jun 21 data	Steady; holding within forecast range of \$5.88-\$6.80 for June. Watch for demand signal from Chinese PMI.

Sources: Trading Economics, OilPrice.com, Trading Economics/FRED, CarbonCredits.com

8. Rates & FX

DATA AS OF ~06:00 BST

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	NOTE
US 10Y Treasury	4.50%	+~3bp	Briefly hit 4.5% overnight for first time since June 12; hawkish Fed pricing.
German Bund 10Y	n/a	n/a	Not sourced at time of collection. ECB at 2.25% deposit rate.
EUR/USD	1.1430	Soft	USD rate advantage outweighs ECB hike. ECB raised to 2.25% June 11.
GBP/USD	1.3400	Under pressure	UK PM Starmer resignation adding political risk premium.
DXY (Dollar Index)	100.90	Elevated	Highest level since May 2025; driven by hawkish Fed and elevated US CPI (4.2% in May).

Sources: Trading Economics, CNBC, Forex.com, StreetStats Finance

9. DCM — Primary Bond Market

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES (22 JUNE 2026)

Specific deal-by-deal data for June 22 was not available from web sources at time of collection. The European corporate IG issuance pace in 2026 has been strong: aggregate Eurobond sales by US issuers reached a record \$100B by September 2025, a trend that continued into 2026. European gross government bond issuance is tracking near EUR 1.4 trillion for the year. For specific transactions check Bloomberg/IFR morning wrap.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED TODAY (23 JUNE 2026)

- J.P. Morgan Natural Resources Conference (NYC, June 23–24) may generate corporate announcement flow from energy, mining, and renewables names.
- European IG corporate window expected to remain open ahead of Q3 summer slowdown. Issuers likely to front-run the summer lull.
- SSA / EU bond pipeline: European Commission targeting EUR 100B long-term bond issuance by end-June 2026; final transactions possible this week.
- Specific mandated deals: check Bloomberg / IFR DCM wire for intraday updates.

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL (BPS)	CHANGE	DIRECTION
iTraxx Main (5Y)	n/a	n/a	n/a
iTraxx Crossover (5Y)	n/a	n/a	n/a
CDX IG (5Y)	n/a	n/a	n/a
Avg Euro Corp IG Spread	n/a	n/a	n/a

iTraxx/CDX live spread data not available via public web search. Verify via Bloomberg or ICE/Markit terminal.

COMMENTARY

Primary market tone is constructive heading into the final week of June. The window remains open but is narrowing as the summer blackout approaches. ECB rate increases to 2.25% have compressed EUR-denominated carry but investor appetite for IG corporate bonds remains solid given the EU fiscal expansion backdrop and improving Eurozone growth data. High-yield issuance has been selective; industrials and transport names have been active. Energy sector issuers face wider spreads as oil volatility persists. Financial issuers continue to benefit from steeper yield curves.

10. Economic Calendar — 23 June 2026

LONDON TIME	REGION	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
All day	US	\$69B 2-Year Treasury Note Auction	Yield ~4.85%	HIGH
TBC	US	FedEx Q4 FY2026 Earnings (after US close)	EPS \$5.91 / Rev \$24.18B	HIGH
Various	Global	4 macro events scheduled (Yahoo Finance Economic Calendar)	Specifics n/a	MEDIUM
Thursday	US	PCE Prices (May) — key Fed data point	n/a	HIGH
Thursday	US	Q1 GDP — Third Estimate	n/a	HIGH
Wednesday	US	Micron Q3 FY2026 Earnings	Rev \$34.66B / EPS \$19.95	HIGH

Specific times for Eurozone and UK June 23 releases not retrieved. Check Econoday / ECB calendar. Sources: Yahoo Finance, TradingKey, BeinCrypto

11. Corporate Events & Earnings

FedEx (FDX) — Q4 FY2026 earnings after US market close today (June 23). First quarter as a pure-play logistics and parcel firm following the FedEx Freight spin-off on June 1. Consensus: EPS \$5.91, revenue \$24.18B. Stock near \$336, close to 52-week high of \$345. Watch Network 2.0 cost savings update and FY2027 guidance.

Micron Technology (MU) — Q3 FY2026 earnings after US close on Wednesday June 24. Consensus: Revenue \$34.66B, EPS \$19.95. The single biggest AI/memory-cycle test of the week. Stock up ~280% in 2026 on HBM demand. Analyst consensus "Strong Buy." HBM4 ramp detail is the key watch.

J.P. Morgan Natural Resources Conference — June 23–24, New York. Energy, Power, Renewables & Mining. May generate announcement flow from sector names; watch for guidance updates from mining and energy companies.

US Treasury \$69B 2-Year Note Auction — Today. Results will test demand for short-dated paper at current yield levels. A weak result (wide tail) would accelerate the rate-hike trade and pressure equities.

FTSE Russell Semi-Annual Reconstitution — June 2026 reconstitution is underway (run-up period). Technology and Industrials each added 18 names to the Russell 1000. Rebalancing flows may affect individual names into month-end.

14 EARNINGS RELEASES SCHEDULED TODAY PER MARKETSCREENER/TRADINGECONOMICS. FULL LIST: CHECK MARKETSCREENER CORPORATE CALENDAR.

12. Stocks to Watch

FDX FedEx Corp	Q4 FY2026 earnings post-close today. First print as pure-play parcel/logistics after Freight spin-off. Consensus EPS \$5.91, rev \$24.18B. Key watch: FY2027 guidance and Network 2.0 savings trajectory. Stock near 52W high (~\$336). Potential volatility event regardless of direction.	VOL
MU Micron Technology	Earnings tomorrow (June 24). Pre-announcement positioning likely active today. Up ~280% YTD on AI/HBM demand. Analyst "Strong Buy" consensus; HBM4 ramp is the catalyst to confirm. Any miss could dent the broader AI semiconductor trade.	BULL
GE GE Aerospace	Up +6.7% last week to \$357 as the US-Iran deal reduces airline fuel cost fears. Aviation sector broadly supported. Watch for consolidation or further re-rating as Hormuz reopening normalises jet-fuel prices.	BULL
NOC Northrop Grumman	Most closely tied to the US nuclear triad — Pentagon's top priority. Defense budgets remain elevated globally. Less oil-sensitive than pure-energy names. Structural tailwind from geopolitical spending.	BULL
LMT Lockheed Martin	F-35, F-22 supplier; Sikorsky helicopter unit; large missile and growing space business. Defense budget strength supports revenue visibility. Post-Iran deal, watch for any escalation/de-escalation news impacting defence stocks.	BULL
KEY KeyCorp	+45.7% YoY; closed at \$22.59. Remains attractively valued per undervaluation screens. Higher-for-longer rate environment benefits net interest income. Regional bank names benefiting from steeper yield curve.	BULL
Energy Sector XLE / Integrated Majors	Down 5.63% MTD as oil plummets from \$119 peak. Today: watch whether WTI finds support near \$73 or continues to slide. OPEC+ response to Hormuz reopening is the key unknown. Integrated majors (BP, Shell, TotalEnergies, ExxonMobil, Chevron) all pressured.	BEAR
IPX / VA IperionX / Vertical Aerospace	IperionX (critical minerals/titanium for aerospace/defence; A\$1.5B cap) and Vertical Aerospace (VX4 eVTOL; testing and certification progress) are analyst-highlighted thematic plays for June. High-risk, long-duration names; for contextual monitoring.	WATCH

13. Macro / Corporate / Political Highlights

MACRO

1. US CPI 4.2% (May) — Highest since April 2023. Energy prices up 23% YoY drove the spike; base effects and Hormuz reopening should pull this lower over summer. But the damage to Fed credibility is done: 70% probability of a September rate hike is now priced.

2. Fed split — 9/19 policymakers favour a 2026 hike — The \$69B 2-year auction today and Thursday's PCE print are the next macro inputs. A hot PCE (above 2.8%) would cement September as near-certain. A soft print could reduce odds sharply and trigger a bond rally.

3. ECB raised deposit rate to 2.25% — ECB projects Eurozone headline inflation at 3.0% in 2026, 2.3% in 2027, and 2.0% in 2028. A fragile geopolitical environment (Middle East peace deal "remains fragile") is cited as a downside risk. EUR/USD is soft at 1.143 as dollar rate advantage persists.

CORPORATE

1. FedEx Freight spin-off (June 1) — FDX is now a pure-play logistics and parcel business. Today's Q4 print is the first earnings report post-transformation. Network 2.0 restructuring is ongoing; watch margin expansion guidance.

2. Micron +280% YTD — AI memory cycle in focus — The company is the largest pure-play beneficiary of HBM demand for AI accelerators. Tomorrow's Q3 report (June 24) is the most consequential data point for the AI semiconductor trade this week. Consensus projects \$34.66B revenue and \$19.95 EPS.

3. Russell reconstitution 2026 — Technology and Industrials each added 18 names to the Russell 1000 in the June 2026 semi-annual reconstitution. Total Russell 3000 market cap rose 29% to \$75.6T. Rebalancing flows are active.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

1. US-Iran 60-day ceasefire extension MoU — Hormuz reopens, US naval blockade lifted, Iranian assets unfrozen, sanctions partially lifted, Iran pledges no nuclear weapon. Market is "front-running the best-case scenario" per analysts. Any implementation failure would spike oil. The permanent deal negotiation is the longer-term watch.

2. UK PM Starmer resignation — Political leadership vacuum in the UK creates fiscal policy uncertainty. GBP/USD near 1.34. Markets are watching whether the Conservative or Labour successor signals a shift on taxation, spending, or Brexit-era trade relationships.

3. Russia-Ukraine ongoing / US Treasury holdings — US Treasuries held by official institutions at the NY Fed fell to \$2.7T in March 2026, the lowest since 2012. Russia reportedly selling gold to fund war expenditure. Geopolitical risk to financial stability is elevated, per RBA Bulletin (June 2026).

14. Key Themes — Top 5 by Horizon

TODAY'S TOP 5

1. FedEx Q4 Earnings

First results as a pure-play logistics firm post Freight spin-off; FY2027 guidance sets the tone for the entire logistics and transport sector. Stock near 52W high. Miss on revenue or disappointing guidance would weigh on transport and industrials broadly.

2. \$69B 2-Year Treasury Auction

A tail (weak demand) accelerates the rate-hike trade, pressuring growth equities and emerging markets. A stop-through (strong demand) would give bond bulls temporary relief and cap yield upside.

3. Hormuz Reopening — Oil Adjustment

Markets are absorbing the removal of the 14M bbl/day supply shortfall. WTI near \$73.67; Energy sector down 5.63% MTD. Key question: does OPEC+ adjust output to support prices, or does the market reprice to a new lower equilibrium?

4. Dollar Strength vs. EUR and GBP

DXY at 100.90, highest since May 2025. USD strength is a headwind for gold, commodities, and EM. EUR/USD at 1.143 and GBP/USD at 1.34. Starmer resignation adds idiosyncratic GBP risk on top of the dollar macro driver.

5. Euro Stoxx 50 Pre-Open Recovery

Futures point to +0.38% open from the -0.30% June 22 close. Energy drag should ease given oil stability; but yield-sensitive sectors (utilities, real estate) face Fed-related pressure. Net: cautiously positive open with sector divergence.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

1. Micron Q3 FY2026 Earnings (Wed June 24)

The clearest test of the AI semiconductor boom's durability. Consensus \$34.66B revenue, \$19.95 EPS. A beat and strong HBM4 guidance would validate the +280% YTD move; a miss would trigger broad AI sector repricing.

2. PCE Inflation Data (Thu June 25)

May PCE is the Fed's preferred inflation gauge. Hot reading above 2.8% would cement a September rate hike. Soft reading below 2.5% would reprice the 70% probability down sharply and spark a bond and equity rally.

3. Q1 GDP Third Estimate (Thu June 25)

Final read on US growth. Any downward revision raises stagflation concern (high inflation + weak growth) which would complicate the Fed's path and is bearish for risk assets.

4. US-Iran MoU Implementation Watch

Markets are watching daily for Hormuz transit data and Iranian compliance with the MoU. Any setback (missile incident, inspection dispute, sanctions violation) would reprice oil sharply higher and reverse the energy sector decline.

5. Russell 2000 at 3,000 — Follow-Through

The historic milestone at 3,000 attracts momentum and media attention. Watch whether institutional money rotates into small-caps or treats the level as resistance. Strong follow-through would signal genuine risk-on breadth.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

1. Fed September Rate Hike Path

The dominant theme for June: will the 70% September probability stick? PCE, GDP, and employment data this week and next will either cement or reduce it. A confirmed hike cycle restart would reprice the entire rates curve.

2. ECB Policy Cycle and Eurozone Inflation

ECB raised to 2.25% this month with inflation forecast at 3.0% for 2026. The next Governing Council meeting and incoming Eurozone CPI data will determine whether this is the last hike or the start of a new tightening leg.

3. Oil Market Normalisation Post-Hormuz

Brent has fallen from \$119 to sub-\$78. OPEC+'s response is the unknown: does the cartel cut to support the \$80 floor, or does production increase from Iran's return compress margins further? Energy sector earnings and capex guidance in Q2 season will reflect this.

4. UK Political Vacuum

Post-Starmer UK faces leadership transition risk. Fiscal policy continuity, BoE independence perception, and the trade relationship with the EU are all at play. GBP/USD could test 1.30 if the transition looks disorderly.

5. Q2 Earnings Season Ramp-Up (July)

FedEx and Micron are advance indicators. The full Q2 season kicks off in July with banks and financials. Guidance will reflect the impact of the Iran conflict, oil price swings, and the consumer under 4.2% CPI. Corporate margins are the key watch.

15. Key Trends to Watch

1 DAY — WHAT COULD MOVE TODAY'S SESSION

FedEx post-close earnings: Logistics and transport sector catalyst; Network 2.0 guidance will determine if the stock holds near 52-week highs or corrects.

\$69B 2-year Treasury auction: Demand determines yield direction and feeds directly into the rate-hike narrative. Result expected early afternoon London time.

Oil price range: WTI at \$73.67. Watch whether OPEC+ commentary emerges to support prices after Hormuz reopening. Energy stocks (BP, Shell, TotalEnergies) move with this.

USD/GBP political premium: Any UK political announcement (successor to Starmer named, policy pivot signalled) moves GBP/USD from 1.34. Watch FX desks.

1 WEEK — KEY APPOINTMENTS AND THEMES

Micron Q3 (Wed June 24): Most consequential earnings print of the week. Result will drive the AI semiconductor trade for weeks, not days.

PCE and GDP (Thu June 25): Two data releases on the same day that could either validate or undermine the 70% September hike probability. Both releases affect the dollar, bonds, and equity sector rotation simultaneously.

UK leadership clarity: A named successor to Starmer by week-end would reduce GBP/USD uncertainty. Absence of clarity extends the political risk premium.

Hormuz transit data: First week of reopening — any disruption (incident, inspection delay) would be the first real test of the ceasefire's durability.

1 MONTH — MAJOR DEADLINES AND UNDERLYING TRENDS

Fed July/September meeting path: PCE and CPI data through July will lock in or unwind the rate-hike trade. Dollar and bond markets are the transmission mechanism.

US-Iran 60-day MoU window: Expires in mid-August. If permanent deal negotiations stall, oil risk premium returns. Energy equities, airlines, shipping, and chemical sectors are all exposed.

Q2 earnings season (July): Bank earnings open the season. Corporate margins, consumer health under 4.2% inflation, and energy input cost normalisation are the three central narratives.

ECB next Governing Council meeting: Inflation at 3.0% in 2026 leaves open the possibility of another hike. EUR/USD trajectory depends on whether the ECB catches up to or diverges further from the Fed's implied rate path.

Sources: Reuters | Bloomberg | CNBC | TheStreet | Yahoo Finance | Al Jazeera | OilPrice.com | Trading Economics | Forex.com | ECB (ecb.europa.eu) | CME FedWatch | Investtech | StreetStats Finance | TradingKey | BeinCrypto | LSEG/FTSE Russell | GlobalCapital | Amundi Research | RBA Bulletin | Morningstar | Zacks | MarketScreener | S&P Global DJI (iTraxx methodology) | FRED St. Louis Fed

Data collected automatically between 05:30 and 06:45 BST on 23 June 2026. Some data points marked n/a where live sources were unavailable at collection time. Verify all figures before making any investment or trading decision. This briefing is for informational purposes only.